technological relations have recently grown, including investments in electronics assembly and semiconductor supply chains. Along with some or all of its Quad partners, India has also occasionally participated in ‘Quad-plus’ exercises and activities, involving such countries as France, South Korea, the Philippines, Canada, and New Zealand.

Perhaps the trickiest balance that India will have to strike in the Indo–Pacific is with Russia. India has for many years been Russia’s largest arms market, but concerns about a deepening China–Russia compact after the 2014 Crimea crisis and the Russia–Ukraine war after 2022 have exposed differences, including over Russia’s nascent security relationship with Pakistan. India believes that positive relations with Russia will be vital to preserving a balance of power in Asia and it hopes to provide Moscow with options. For the near future, India will remain somewhat dependent on Russia for its military preparedness. It has benefited from advanced Russian technology (such as nuclear propulsion for leased submarines) and after 2022 has imported significant amounts of oil. At the same time, broader trade relations and people-to-people ties between India and Russia have struggled, and Western sanctions have complicated payment methods for trade. Despite criticism from the media and publics in the West, India has opted to continue investing in the relationship with Russia, which has rendered certain benefits for Indian security, economy, and foreign relations. One example is the sale of BrahMos cruise missiles—which were jointly developed by India and Russia—to the Philippines, in order to contribute to its security in the South China Sea. But the India–Russia relationship will be one that must be carefully managed in light of the changing geopolitics of the Indo–Pacific.

Equally, while the Indo–Pacific balance naturally has a maritime focus, there are important continental considerations at play. In addition to Russia, Indian outreach and engagement with the five Central Asian republics and Mongolia will remain important. To this end, India has been involved in the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO). New Delhi also hosted the five leaders of the Central Asian republics for Republic Day in 2022, during which agreements on investment, education, and health cooperation were